

Writing User Stories

” ~~DOZVKDM~~ *unlimited desires but limited resources*

” ~~KDMUHTXLUHPHQVZLFKEFHVVVLWDWH~~
communication with those who can provide
the solution to said requirement.

Negotiation over Contracts

„
to solve their problems, we need to stop DVNLQ and to involve ~~ADW~~ - Mike Cohn

„ Involving a product owner in the refinement of their requirements via User Stories saves:

- o **Time:** would you rather write a novella of requirements or simply an outline?
- o **Money:** Legal fees in contract review; contractual change orders

A Story template

³As a <User or role>

I want <Business Functionality>

So that %VLEVV-XVWLILFDWLRQ

Example:

As a Account Holder,

I want to be able to withdraw funds from my checking account,

So that I can buy some bling.

Stories are not

f ³mini

f a complete specification

f a contract

f intended to be interpreted without a
Product Owner

What is an Epic?

- „ Are usually compound Stories, that can be broken down into several smaller, more focused stories
- „ May encompass enough work for several Sprints (iterations)

User Stories guidelines

- „ **Testable.** Tangible acceptance tests can be written against any delivered software
- „ The scope of the User Story is manage-able enough for the team to provide an **Estimate**
- „ **Independent** and do not rely on other Stories
- „ **Sized appropriately.** Have a level of effort which the team can comfortably achieve in the duration of a single iteration

Some places to consider breaking Epics

- „ At C.R.U.D boundaries
- „ At system boundaries where two systems interface
- „ At Happy-Path / Exception-Path boundaries

At CRUD boundaries

” This solution is commonly used in environments that interact with a database

” Example:

\$DQFFRXQWKROGHU,ZQWREHRSHQFKHFNLQFFRXQ«

As an account holder, I want to deposit a check into my
FKHFNLQFFRXQ«

As an account holder, I want to view the updated balance in my
FKHFNLQFFRXQ«

At system boundaries

- „ This solution is commonly used in environments where there are a large number of legacy systems
- „ And can be used:
 - When there is a clear separation between two systems
 - Where the interface between the two systems is well understood
- „ Beware of creating dependencies between two different projects

At Happy-Path / Exception-Path boundaries:

- „ Commonly used when transitioning from Use Cases
- „ The happy-path scenario may still need to be decomposed
- „ Breaking down Use Cases can be a lot of
BUNKWPDEHVLPSOHUWRMXVWVWDUWXVLQ
User Stories

What are Acceptance Criteria?

- ” Product Owner *expectations* on what will be delivered
- ” Acceptance Criteria can include:
 - o Functionality that the system will perform
 - o Interface look and feel
 - o Necessary documentation (eg. SOX compliance documentation)

Guidelines: Acceptance Criteria

„ Be explicit

- ~~KHV~~VWHPZOGLVSODWKHGDWH«
- ~~QD~~WIRUPDW,V\$ULO VW'acceptable?

„ Provide examples for clarity

- ~~KHV~~VWHPGDWHZOOEHGLVSODHGLQWKHIRUPDW'

„ List any assumptions that the team may not be fully aware of

Guidelines: Acceptance Criteria

KHFKHFNLDFFRXQVEDODQHZOOEHXSGDWHGZWK
WKHDPRXQWHQHUHGEWKHXVHU'

„ And where ambiguous, what the system is
not expected to do

BIFRQLOLDWLRQWKWKHDPRXQVRIIXQVGHSRVLWHG
QWHQSHFWHGDWWKLVWLPH'

Questions?

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References

Adapted from [Kane Marv](#) ³ [Writing Stories](#)

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<http://www.ScrumAlliance.org>